

ROOKIE RISING

The 2025 season will see multiple teams **looking to the future,** investing in young drivers who can get to grips with the top tier of motorsport racing.

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With just a year to go before the new regulations kick in, F1 in 2025 could be a lottery of sorts. With the focus firmly on maximising resources for 2026, any shortcomings that teams identify before and during the sporting year could well be neglected, irrespective of their position in the championship ladder.

The one-off season, therefore, has allowed multiple teams to look to the future, investing in rookie drivers who can get to grips with the top tier of motorsport racing before facing the unpredictable.

Among the six drivers who will race full-time this year, three have already had the opportunity to get behind the wheel at an F1 Grand Prix. With the advantage of some race weekend experience — be it only one — these rookies have gained invaluable experience ahead of their first full season.

While learning the ropes will still be the priority, strong performances amid the uncertainty will help them

build for the future. Moreover, if they score a couple of points over the first few races, a lot of heads will turn.

Liam Lawson

The most experienced among the inexperienced drivers on the grid, with eleven race appearances under his belt, Liam Lawson (**below**) is set to take on possibly the biggest challenge in the sport — fighting four-time World Champion Max Verstappen in equal machinery.

The Red Bull Racing second seat has been a revolving door since Daniel Ricciardo's transfer to Renault in 2019. Pierre Gasly had a torrid time with the Red Bull car after making the step up from Toro Rosso (now called Racing Bulls). His successor, Alexander Albon, was overlooked when the chance to sign race winner Sergio Perez came up.

